

7. International Date Line

Std 9th

Sub – Geography

Q 1. Two boxes in different hemispheres are given in the following diagram. The IDL passes through both the boxes. In one box, the meridian, day and date is given. Find the day and date for the other box.



Ans. Tuesday 16th Aug.



Ans. Sunday 25th Dec.

Q 2. Select the correct option :

(1) While crossing the IDL, a person will have to add one day when travelling from

Ans. East to West

(2) If it is Wednesday 10 a.m. at 15° E meridian, then what will be the time at IDL?

Ans. Wednesday 9 p.m.

(3) According to the international convention, at which meridian does the day and date change occurs?

Ans. 180°

(4) At which direction of the IDL does a new day start immediately?

Ans. West

(5) IDL brings coordination in which of the following?

Ans. Transportation schedules

Q 3. Give geographical reasons

(1) IDL is proving to be very useful in today's times

Ans. (i) The IDL brings coordination between international airlines, transportation services, economic and trade activities.

(ii) The IDL has been carved out of necessity of coordinating time and date. It is also important in today's modern era and rapidly happening global developments.

(iii) We can keep a track of all the calculations of day and time accurately with the help of IDL in case of global transportation esp. with respect to airways.

(iv) It is only because of the IDL that the schedules of the traffic worldwide are organised properly.

(2) The day starts in Pacific Ocean on the earth

Ans. (i) If the new day started on any land part it would have led to a confusion on the day and date to the west and east of that place.

(ii) To avoid this the new date and day starts and ends on IDL.

(iii) IDL is drawn with reference to 180° meridian which Passes through the Pacific Ocean.

(iv) That is why, the new day starts in the Pacific Ocean on the earth.

Q 4. Write in brief:

(1) What considerations have been made while deciding the IDL?

Ans. (i) Our 24-hour day starts at 12 midnight. Because of the earth's rotation, midnight occurs at different times at different places.

(ii) An attempt has been made to make the IDL pass through the Pacific Ocean completely. Had it passed through land or some islands, the people there would have had to follow different dates and timings because dates would have been different on their eastern and western parts.

(iii) Also, it would have been difficult to know when one crosses the IDL on land and when the date changes on the calendar.

(iv) Therefore, the IDL is not a straight line like the 180° meridian. At places, it turns east while at other places, it turns west.

(2) While crossing the IDL, what changes will you make?

Ans. (i) If IDL is crossed while traveling towards the east, a previous date and day than the original date of travel would be considered.

(ii) If IDL is crossed while traveling towards the west, next date and day would be considered than the original date Of travel.

(3) Why is the IDL not a straight line like the 180° meridian?

Ans. (i) If IDL passed through the land part of some country, it would have led to confusion of two different dates and days in the same country.

(ii) Besides, being an imaginary line it would have been difficult to track when and where exactly the IDL has been crossed.

(iii) Hence, to avoid confusion, International Date Line was drawn in such a way that it will pass through only the Pacific Ocean.

(4) Why doesn't the IDL pass through land?

Ans. (i) If IDL passed through the land part of some country, it would have led to confusion of two different dates and days in the same country.

(ii) Besides, being an imaginary line it would have been difficult to track when and where exactly the IDL has been crossed.

(iii) Hence, to avoid confusion, International Date Line was drawn in such a way that it will pass through only the Pacific Ocean.

(5) Why is the IDL considered with respect to the 180° meridian only?

Ans. (i) With some exceptions, 180° meridian passes maximum over the water part\ocean.

(ii) Hence, 180° meridian was used to draw the IDL.

Q 5. Using an atlas, tell in which of the following routes the IDL will be crossed and show them on the map.

(1) Mumbai- London- New York- Los Angeles- Tokyo

(2) Delhi- Kolkata- Singapore- Melbourne

(3) Kolkata- Hong Kong- Tokyo- San Francisco

(4) Chennai-Singapore- Tokyo- Sydney- Santiago

(5) Delhi-London-New York